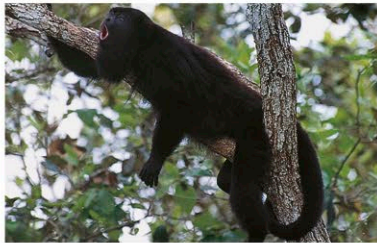


Alouatta pigra

Guatemalan black howler



Length 20½–28 in (52–71 cm)
Tail 20–27 in (50–69 cm)
Weight 10–20 lb (4.5–9 kg)
Location Mexico, Central America
Social unit Group
Status Endangered



Once considered a subspecies of the mantled howler (*Alouatta palliata*), this monkey is completely black, apart from the male's white scrotal sac. Loud whoops and howls at dawn and dusk proclaim a troop's territory, which may be up to 62 acres (25 hectares). Most troops comprise about 7 members with just one male, who is up to twice as heavy as a female. This monkey eats a plentiful, low-nutrient, leafy diet.

Alouatta seniculus

Colombian red howler



Length 19–25 in (48–63 cm)
Tail 20½–32 in (52–80 cm)
Weight 8¾–20 lb (4–9 kg)
Location N.W. South America
Social unit Group
Status Least concern

Colombian red howlers are the largest of the 12 howler monkey species, whose loud howls, whoops, and other calls carry more than 1¼ miles (2 km) through the forest, informing others of a troop's presence or conveying alarm signals. They live mainly in groups of one male and 3–4 females. The male is much heavier than the female. When a new male ousts an existing male from a troop, he may kill the latter's offspring, so that the females become ready to breed with him sooner.



GOLDEN SADDLE
The northern red howler (shown here) has a reddish gold "saddle" on the body, which contrasts with the maroon head, shoulders, and limbs. Other populations are a uniform red color.

TREETOP LIFE

Like all howlers, the Colombian red howler is wonderfully adapted to life among trees. Its prehensile tail lacks fur on the underside near the tip, to help it grip and work as a fifth grasping limb. Its climbing ability provides access to a wide variety of leaves and fruit. Howlers need to consume up to 2¼ lb (1 kg) daily of this plentiful, but low-energy, diet. They spend up to three-quarters of the day resting to conserve energy.



long face

strong, prehensile tail that can support body weight

Pithecia monachus

Monk saki

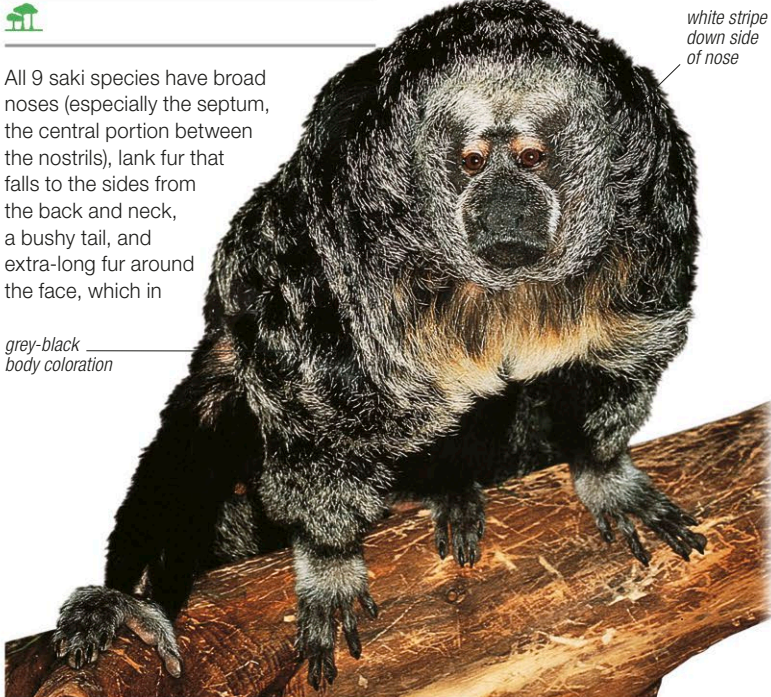


Length 16–20 in (41–50 cm)
Tail 16–20 in (40–50 cm)
Weight 3¼–6½ lb (1.5–3 kg)
Location N. and W. South America
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



All 9 saki species have broad noses (especially the septum, the central portion between the nostrils), lank fur that falls to the sides from the back and neck, a bushy tail, and extra-long fur around the face, which in

grey-black body coloration



the monk, or red-bearded, saki forms a hood or cowl. Compared to many other New World monkeys, this saki is shy and quiet, preferring to stay high in the trees, keep still, and remain unnoticed. It can make a loud alarm call, but under threat its main defense is to bare its teeth. Its diet is fruit and seeds, and it lives in close-knit troops of 4–5, who spend much time grooming each other.

Pithecia pithecia

White-faced saki



Length 11–18 in (28–46 cm)
Tail 12¾–18 in (32.5–46 cm)
Weight 3¼–4½ lb (1.4–1.9 kg)
Location N. South America
Social unit Group/Pair
Status Least concern



No other New World monkey has such differences between the sexes: the male is black with a white or pale gold face and a black nose, while the

female is gray-brown with pale tipped hairs and a dark face. Although it is vegetarian, its teeth have a predatory appearance, with sharp incisors for impaling fruit and long canines to crack seeds and nuts. A typical group is a female, male, and 1–3 young.



pale face (male only)

white nose stripe (female only)

Chiropotes satanas

Black-bearded saki



Length 13–18 in (33–46 cm)
Tail 12–18 in (30–46 cm)
Weight 4½–8¾ lb (2–4 kg)
Location N. South America
Social unit Group
Status Critically endangered



In this species, the typical saki's long chin fur forms a bushy beard, and the long, dense head fur makes a thick forehead fringe. Both feet and hands

grip powerfully and this saki can hang by one limb as it feeds on seeds, hard fruits, and small animals, crushing them with well-developed molar teeth. When excited, it "switches" its tail like a cat and emits a piercing whistle.

